

Ostrich Eggs Party A

Day 1 · Session 1 · ABC Drug Company · Assigned role brief

Keep this brief private. Open only your assigned role.

You are the Chief Scientist for the ABC Drug company, an international firm that specializes in drugs to cure rare diseases. Recently there has been a worldwide outbreak of X-Flouxide. This disease is a communicable illness that carries a high risk of causing fetal abnormalities, both physical and mental.

A worldwide emergency exists. Unless X-Flouxide is brought under control quickly, the chances are great that an unacceptably high percentage of an entire generation will be dependent upon their families and society for decades. Economists are predicting that costs would wipe out millions of families and trigger widespread business collapse and unemployment in thousands of consumer industries. Psychologists anticipate that the emotional impact will touch almost every family, with terrible consequences.

Your company has been conducting research on X-Flouxide and has identified a serum, Agent UO, that will prevent the disease. The serum is produced from the yolk of the eggs of the rare spotted ostrich. This bird is found in small numbers in Africa. They lay their eggs once each year and their laying period is this month. The eggs for each year are carefully stored and then sold to gourmet restaurants as thickeners for special soups. Last year's egg supply has all been sold at an average price of \$15 per egg.

The only owner of domesticated spotted ostriches, and consequently the major supplier, lives in a remote part of Africa. You do not think that he knows about this new use for his produce.

Ostrich Eggs Party A continued

The ABC Drug Company will need all 10,000 of this year's production of the spotted ostrich eggs in order to meet the projected serum needs, worldwide. Half of the serum will be needed in the western hemisphere; one-fifth will be needed for the United States. Your assignment is to get as many spotted ostrich eggs as you can (preferably, all the eggs). Your company has authorized you to spend as much as \$500,000 to get this year's crop.

There appears to be competitors for use of spotted ostrich eggs – a chemical manufacturer called the XYZ Company. (Your company has a pending law suit against them for patent violations.) You have been authorized to compete with the XYZ Company for the produce, and will match their bidding dollar for dollar up to your limit so that you can get 100 % of the produce.

You are flying to Africa to try to buy the eggs. Now, you have discovered that the person in the seat next to you is the agent for the XYZ Company.

You are going to try to convince this person that your need for the produce is so great that your company should get all of this year's crop. If you can protect the interests of the ABC Company you will certainly be named the next President of the Company – a job that will pay you five times your present salary.